

Workbook - Mental Bank Seminar

Learning Objectives

Upon completing this lesson, you should be proficient in the following areas:

Knowledge

- Learn the Mental Bank process and why it is so effective.
- Understand what homeostasis is and how it applies to behavior.
- Learn the Recipe for Success.

Comprehension

- Gain a thorough understanding of the six synergistic ingredients and how they work together.

Application

- Start using the Mental Bank process for yourself.
- Feel comfortable teaching the Mental Bank process to your clients and helping them understand the key concepts as needed.

Learning Approach

The recommended approach to learning is to:

- Use this workbook as a guide for studying the video lecture, take notes as needed, and be prepared to answer the workbook questions in your Q&A with the instructor.
- Begin to set up your Mental Bank.
- Read the suggested text: Success is not an Accident by Dr. John Kappas.
- Complete the open book quiz after the Q&A.

Resources

- Your Class Lecture
- Workbook and Notes
- [Suggested Reading](#)
- [Supplemental Videos](#)

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The Mental Bank

The Mental Bank is a groundbreaking process created and developed by Dr. John Kappas and used worldwide to improve people's lives. Rooted in behavioral science, this powerful method for actualizing success uses incremental steps to transform one's life story on both the conscious and subconscious level, creating meaningful and lasting change where other methods may fall short.

The Mental Bank is one of our most powerful tools as a hypnotherapist. You will find that it reinforces various types of therapies and accelerates progress. It can help your clients with many presenting issues, including procrastination, motivation, goal attainment, prosperity, weight loss, and smoking cessation, to name a few. By using the Mental Bank yourself, you will gain a deep understanding of the process. Not only will doing this prepare you to teach your clients how to use it, but it will also benefit you personally.

What is Homeostasis?

Described by George Kappas as "the most powerful force in human behavior," we could not survive without homeostasis. All living things have an inherent need to stay the same within narrow parameters. The process by which your body and mind maintain this stability is called homeostasis. For example, if you begin to get too hot, your body resists this change by sending a negative feedback loop to your brain. Your brain then activates your sweat glands, which opposes the heat, and you begin to cool down. This happens automatically on a subconscious level. You never even have to think about it.

Homeostasis not only applies to our mind and body but also our behavior and our sense of self. The subconscious mind does not differentiate between positive change and negative change. It has no judgment. It only wants to maintain stability by staying with the known and avoiding the unknown.

Theory of Mind

The Mental Bank program is grounded in Dr. Kappas' model of "Theory of Mind." Knowns represent emotional pleasure to the subconscious mind. Unknowns represent emotional pain to the subconscious. Our knowns become our comfort zone, and our comfort zone dictates a lot of our behavior. If our financial comfort zone is at \$20,000, any time we go much above that, we get uncomfortable and begin to procrastinate or sabotage our success in an attempt to get back to our comfort zone. Anytime we get much below that amount, we get motivated to get back up to our comfort zone.

Starting in childhood, we have experiences that determine how we interact with the world. Based on those experiences, we develop a story about who we are, internal beliefs, and a life script that gets programmed. This story becomes a very strong known to our subconscious. If we want to obtain something that is not in our life script, we need to change our story subconsciously. The Mental Bank is a way to consistently expand our comfort zone upward.

Resistance

It is entirely normal to experience resistance when using the Mental Bank. Like hypnosis, the Mental Bank is a potent means of affecting the subconscious mind, so resistance is expected. Resistance is homeostasis trying to keep you in your comfort zone and is a brilliant sign that we are pulling away from the confines of our subconscious script. Welcome resistance: it is the first step toward change. Our job is to help the client recognize and break through their resistance to change.

The Mental Bank helps us understand our subconscious limitations. It focuses us on our goals and puts us in control of our lives. Here is an important tip from Dr. John Kappas; “The biggest resistance occurs just before the biggest change.”

Synergistic Approach

The Mental Bank uses a synergistic approach. It combines six elements that, when used together, have a more significant impact than when they are used individually. These six synergistic ingredients make up what Dr. Kappas called the recipe for success. It is the result of his years of experience and research into reprogramming the subconscious mind.

There are six (6) synergistic ingredients that make the Mental Bank so profoundly efficacious, they are:

1. **Come to Believe** – We ask that you have an open mind to the idea that your subconscious is a goal machine. Once it accepts a goal as a “known,” it then sends a signal to the universe and attracts makes that goal a reality. We use the phrase “come to believe” because we understand for that many people, this is a difficult concept to accept just because we say so. However, if you can be open to this possibility and you are willing to give the Mental Bank an honest try, you may see for yourself that you find your life-changing and growing for the better after some time. Then perhaps you too may “come to believe.”
2. **Daily Reinforcement** – Repetition is how we learn; it is also a proven method for bypassing the defense mechanism of homeostasis. If you do anything enough times over and over, it starts to become “automatic.” “Automatic” is another way to say it has become subconscious or what Theory of Mind refers to as a “known.” Think of a toddler taking their first steps. That did not happen overnight but rather resulted from months of practicing small incremental steps, slowly learning the necessary coordination, and gaining confidence. Lasting change is created slowly and incrementally through daily repetition. By doing the Mental Bank daily, we override the old unwanted story and reinforce the new one.
3. **Symbolic Language** – The subconscious mind communicates and accepts information differently than we do on a conscious level. Dr. Kappas recognized the importance of symbols when communicating with the subconscious mind. He chose symbols he felt were very powerful and ingrained in the subconscious mind for the Mental Bank. He chose numbers because he knew from his clinical experience that the mind responds very well to numbers. He also chose the “\$” symbol because society has so strongly conditioned us to accept that as a symbol of success and reward. By merging these symbols and associating them with real-life actions and behaviors, it enhances the likelihood of acceptance in the subconscious mind.
4. **Ideomotor Response** – An ideomotor response is something that our body does without us consciously controlling it. Handwriting is an ideomotor response, with cursive being more effective than print. For some people typing on a computer keyboard is an ideomotor response. When doing your Mental Bank, use the one that is the most dominant for you. Using an ideomotor response will bypass our defense mechanisms and deliver a message straight to our subconscious.

5. **Magic 30 Minutes** – Dr. Kappas refers to the last half hour to an hour before a person falls asleep at night as the “Magic 30 Minutes”. During this time, our mind is in a natural state of hypnosis. We have less resistance and are more open to allowing the new story into our subconscious, making this the optimal time to do the Mental Bank.
6. **Dreams** – The positive messages we put into the Mental Bank are passed into the precognitive stage of dreaming, where your mind attempts to predict the most probable future based on the new data that has been inputted that day. The mind will accept the Mental Bank information as a new program, incorporate the new script into its prediction for the future and vent out the old program in the venting stage of dreaming. The Mental Bank allows us to take control of this natural process.

Reality vs. Fantasy

Perhaps the most clever and ingenious aspect of the Mental Bank is the multiple ways it fuses fantasy with reality. In the subconscious mind, there is a fine line between what is real and what is vividly imagined. The more we fuse fantasy with reality, the greater the chances of acceptance by the subconscious mind. Another way to say it is that the more you associate and coningle knowns with unknowns, the less resistance you will trigger from your subconscious mind to accepting the unknowns.

Dr. Kappas' Mental Bank does this on many simple yet innovative levels. For example, your Mental Bank Goal is a fantasy figure based on your Reality Income. You pay yourself fantasy money for real actions and events. You subtract Reality Income from your fantasy balance. It is important to remember that your Mental Bank Goal is your personal symbol for success, based on the "knowns" of your current income.

The Mental Bank Process

The Mental Bank uses income and money as a symbol of success, even if your goals are unrelated to money. Each night during the Magic 30 Minutes, you will use your Mental Bank Ledger and pay yourself fantasy money to take real steps that move you towards your goals. In your ledger, you record your daily successes and rewrite your script.

Before you can begin using your Mental Bank Ledger, you must first figure out your Reality Income. Your Reality Income is whatever money you are receiving annually right now. This income does not have to be money you work for or have earned.

1. **Contract** – The Contract is the written affirmation of your commitment to rewriting your life script. When filling out the contract, you define your Mental Bank Goal by doubling your average yearly income. To figure out your hourly rate for Value Events, cross out the last three zeros of your Mental Bank Goal (i.e., a \$100,000 yearly Mental Bank Goal would equal \$100 per hour.)
2. **Value Events** – Value Events are the actions that, when taken, move us towards achieving our goals. To start, we will focus on three categories when choosing our Value Events – Happiness, Success, and Prosperity. If you want faster results in one area, then focus more on your Value Events in that area. Pick one or two goals for each category and come up with Value Events to accomplish those goals. Choosing your Value Events is perhaps the most crucial step in the Mental Bank program. This is the step where you can greatly assist your clients. It would be helpful if you suggested that you do this part together.

3.

Bonus Events: Standard Value Events are the positive things we should be doing to reach our goals. Bonus Events are things we should be doing but are more difficult for us to do, or they can be the actions that have the most profound impact on our goals. The rate for Bonus Events is double the rate for standard Value Events. It is suggested you have only one or two Bonus Events at a time, but they can change and evolve like all your Value Events.

4. **Deposits** – Each night, you will record all Value Events that you have completed that day as a deposit in your ledger. Value Events are paid at an hourly rate or a flat rate. Next, you will deduct any Reality Income you may have received that day before recording your daily total, and finally, you will fill in your balance forward from previous days.

5. **Happenings** – The Happenings section is essential. While the Value Events represent the positive actions, we take each day. The Happenings section is where we affirm and reinforce the positive things that are happening due to the Mental Bank process. We begin to attract and manifest what is in our new script. Focusing on the positive changes keeps our momentum toward our goals. The subconscious begins to recognize the Happenings as evidence of established knowns.

6.

Affirmations – The word affirmation comes from the Latin word “affirmare,” meaning “to strengthen” An Affirmation is a positive statement that will strengthen our positive beliefs and act as an investment in our new script. You will find these Affirmations more effective than usual because of the synergistic approach of the Mental Bank. Write down three Affirmations a day in the investment section of the ledger or a separate notepad. You can change your Affirmations up as needed or keep them the same for a time.

7.

Tip: The mind will not accept any Affirmation that is too far out of its comfort zone. Choose your wording in a way that feels comfortable to you when you write it. Example: You may consider writing “I am wealthy”; however, if you do not have much money in the bank, the subconscious mind will reject that. So, you may write instead, “I am available to attract wealth opportunities.” or “All my efforts lead to my success.” etc.

Please review the following questions and be prepared to share your answers and thoughts with your instructor during the Q&A.

1. Provide an example of how “homeostasis” has manifested in your own life and sabotaged you from achieving your goals?
2. Think of a presenting issue that a client might have and come up with a few examples of specific Value Events that you would suggest for their Mental Bank.
3. You have a client who just started working with the Mental Bank. He comes back to you two weeks later after a string of negative experiences insisting that the process does not work. How might you help him reframe his experience?
4. What is the purpose of the Happenings section of the Mental Bank?
5. Why does the Mental Bank ask you to subtract your income?
6. What happens when your Mental Bank balance equals your Mental Bank Goal?
7. When is it time to change your Mental Bank Goal amount?
8. Why should some people use the written ledger and others the online ledger?
9. What do you do if you stop the Mental Bank for a period of time and then want to restart?
10. What happens if you miss days in the Mental Bank?
11. What makes the Mental Bank different than self-help programs that focus on positive thinking?

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Sample Value Events List

	STD. EVENTS \$ _____ /HR.	BONUS EVENTS \$ _____ /HR.
S U C C E S S	M.B. Ledger (P/L)	Get expert business advice
	Business Study	Evening classes
	Self-improvement reading	Apply self-improvement techniques
H A P P I N E S S	Family activity	Exercises
	Physical recreation	Monthly weekend trip with partner
	Meditation	Attend religious services
P R O S P E R I T Y	Sales follow-up	Cold calls
	Investment research	Consult financial planner
	Make new family budget	Maintain regular savings plan

Sample Ledger Sheet

Mental Bank Goal: \$ _____						
Date	Value Event	Rate	No. of Hrs.	Deposits	Reality Income	Mental Bank Balance
1	Brought In	\$		\$	\$	\$ 22,900
2	1/2 M.B. Ledger	100	P/L	100		
3	Bus. Study	100	2.25	225		
4	Cold Calls	200	2.0	400		
5	Exercise	200	.5	100		
6	Family Actv.	100	2.0	200		23,925
7	Commissions				400	23,525
8	As of this date I have earned and					
9	accumulated a Mental Bank Balance					
10	of Twenty-three thousand five hundred					
11	Twenty-five dollars. Jane Smith					
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13						
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22						
23						
24						

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EXAMPLE C - VALUE EVENTS

VALUE EVENTS

STD. EVENTS \$ 250/HR.	BONUS EVENTS \$ 500/HR.
- Office work - Sales calls - Listening to motivational tapes - Family activities - Sales follow-up - Self improvement reading - Physical recreation - Developing leads - Eat dinner with whole family	- Mental Bank activity - Evening classes - Contacting new prospects - Apply motivational tapes and books - Exercise at gym - Jogging

EXAMPLE D - LEDGER (301-4) 8.1
MENTAL BANK LEDGER

Mental Bank Goal: \$ 250,000/yr.

Date	Value Event	Rate	No. of Hrs.	Deposits	Reality Income	Mental Bank Balance
	Brought Fwd			\$	\$	\$ 23,800
2/27	Sales calls	250	6.4	1600		
	cont. new prosp.	500	3.0	1500		
	Motiv. tapes	250	1.0	250		
(300)	Exercise	500	0.5	250		27,400
	As of this date I have earned and accumulated twenty seven thousand four hundred dollars.					John Doe
2/28	Sales calls	250	4.0	1000		
	Office wk	250	1.5	375		
	Family activ.	250	2.0	500		
	Evening Clases	500	3.0	1500		
(1875)	Reading (S.I.)	250	2.0	500		31,275
	Commissions				800	30,475
	Bonus check (#100) 300				200	30,575
	As of this date I have earned and accumulated thirty thousand five hundred and seventy five dollars.					John Doe
3/1	Recreation	250	3.0	750		
	Reading	250	2.0	500		
	Jogging	500	1.4	700		
	Family dinner	250	1.0	250		
(1800)	Debt repaid to me			\$600		33,375
	As of this date I have earned and accumulated thirty three thousand three hundred seventy five dollars.					John Doe

MENTAL BANK HAPPENINGS

Date	Happenings
2/27	Almost the end of the month and my sales are fifty percent ahead of my goal for the month. Will revise March goal upward by fifty percent. I will do it!
2/28	Received two new-customer referrals to-day from someone I met last week.
2/1	70-day Charles D. repaid a long-standing debt of six hundred dollars. Quite unexpected. Put it into savings acc.

MENTAL BANK INVESTMENTS

[illegible]

MENTAL BANK INVESTMENTS

Date	Investments
4/15	Transferred from Mental Bank Balance to-day \$5024 ⁰⁰ . Purchased 16 oz gold coin at \$314/00
8/27	Sold 16 oz gold coin (Purch 4/15) at \$345 per oz. = \$5520 ⁰⁰ . Transfer back to M.B. Balance to-day \$500 ⁰⁰ Hold balance of proceeds for reinvestment. (\$5,020)

MENTAL BANK LEDGER

Mental Bank Goal: \$

Date	Value Event	Rate	No. of Hrs.	Deposits	Reality Income	Mental Bank Balance
4/15		\$		\$	\$	\$
	Transfer to Investment acct				5.024	
8/27						
	Transferred from Investment account				500	

[illegible][illegible]

Mental Bank Goal: (301-4) 8.1

[illegible]

Continuing Education Opportunities

Suggested Reading

1. Hypnosis.edu: [Success is not an Accident: The Mental Bank Concept](#)
By: John G. Kappas, Ph.D.
2. Hypnosis.edu: [Professional Hypnotism Manual](#)
By: John G. Kappas, Ph.D.
3. Wikipedia.org: [Professor John A. Bargh](#)
4. AcmeLab.Yale.edu: [From Brain Science, New Questions about Free Will](#)
By: John A. Bargh Cited by Science News
5. AcmeLab.Yale.edu PDF: [Nonconscious Motivations: Their Activation, Operation, and Consequences](#)
By: Tanya L. Chartrand, John A. Bargh
6. [Behavioral Priming: It's All in the Mind, but Whose Mind?](#)
By: Stéphane Doyen, Olivier Klein, Cora-Lise Pichon, Axel Cleeremans

Supplemental Videos

1. Free CEU Seminar: [Mental Bank Seminar – Online Course](#)
2. HMI Video: How to Setup and Use Your Online Mental Bank Ledger
3. YouTube Video: Discussion on How to Attract Success, Happiness, and Prosperity in 5 Minutes a Day
Radio Interview with George J. Kappas
4. YouTube Video: The Backwards Brain Bicycle – I highly recommend you watch this short video on the “Backwards Bicycle”. It is a great illustration of neuroplasticity and the importance of repetition in subconscious change. I like to use this as a demonstration clip in my Mental Bank class. It could also be used as an illustration in Habit Control and any other subconscious behavior change. The more you watch it, the more little gems you will pick up.
5. ELE: [Dr. Kappas Atlanta Series – Graduate Course](#)
6. [American Hypnosis Association – Media Library](#)

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